

FDS0: Foundations of FDS

Seminar 1: Nature of FDS

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The Field of Dream Studio

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What FDS Is

FDS in One Sentence

FDS is a non-profit game development team.

Founded on 2 February 2017, rebuilt on 30 March 2022. The Charter (Article 1) describes the aim as a relaxed creative platform where profits sustain the work, not the members.

Game development is the centre.

Code, art, design, builds, and the research and infrastructure that support them. Other activities exist around the centre, but the centre is the games.

Member organization.

FDS is owned and run by its members, not by a company or a school. Membership is a real commitment with named roles and named responsibilities.

Where FDS Lives

Main FDS sites.

- <https://fds.moe> – the main FDS site.
- <https://doc.fds.moe> – official documentation, named by the Charter (Article 3).

Sub-group sites.

- <https://sf.fds.moe> – Project-StarFall.
- <https://pmine.rs> – PMINE.

FDS is multi-regional.

Members come from mainland China, Taiwan, Hong Kong, Japan, Vietnam, and elsewhere. FDS materials may be authored in English, Japanese, or Chinese.

What FDS Is Not

Not a club.

A club is a place to meet people who share an interest. FDS includes that, but the central artifact is the work, not the meetings.

Not a course.

A course is a fixed syllabus a teacher delivers to students. FDS does not work that way. What you do at FDS comes from your interests, the people around you, and the workstreams that are active.

Not a company at its core.

A company has employees, salaries, and a product owner. The FDS core is non-profit, with members and contributions; the core relationship is not employment.



What FDS Produces

Sub-groups Today

FDS is organized into sub-groups.

Each sub-group has its own focus, its own people, and its own site. The Charter (Article 16) calls these "groups" and gives them independent financial and regulatory systems.

Two of the sub-groups currently active.

- **Project-StarFall.** The sub-group that developed FDS0. Site: `sf.fds.moe`.
- **PMINE.** Research-focused. Currently the sub-group with the most external resources. Site: `pmine.rs`.

Others exist.

The current mix is a present state, not a permanent identity.

What FDS Is Working On (2026)

PMINE side.

Hotaru, FDS's own Rust web framework (`crates.io`). **HCR (Hair Cutting Robot)**, a joint research project with Prof. Aquil (`github.com/fds-pmine/hcr-lecture-2026`). Plus adaptive learning, safe plugin architecture, clinical AI – the full list is on `pmine.rs`.

Project-StarFall side.

DocServer maintenance (`doc.fds.moe`), **Akari** (a Rust template and parsing library on `crates.io`), and the creative community at `sf.fds.moe`.

Entry points exist on both sides.

New members are routed through FDS0, covered in the next section.

How FDS Got Here

A short timeline.

- **2022.** FDS rebuilt (Charter Article 1).
- **2024.** Minecraft and GalGame work within Project-StarFall.
- **Start of 2025.** The technical effort lost momentum; the creative thread continued.
- **March 2025.** PMINE.org's account system development failed; the project paused.
- **Mid 2025 onward.** FDS started building its own web framework (now Hotaru) in Rust.
- **Late 2025.** PMINE began working with Prof. Aquil; framework work converted into joint research, producing HCR. Where Project-StarFall start working on Programming Language Theory.

The shape this leaves.

The current centre of gravity is what FDS could build with the people, time, and partners it has. FDS is still rebuilding itself, and that is honest.



Where FDS Is Going

What FDS Is Working Toward

The long-term goal.

FDS exists so its core members can together build something great. The FDS *core* is non-profit (Charter Article 1); profits there sustain the work, not individuals.

Where member livelihood can grow.

Two slots sit alongside the non-profit core. Members can join a sub-group, and FDS permits subordinate for-profit companies attached to sub-groups. Both are real structural paths for cases where contribution becomes a livelihood.

Member control of groups arrives later.

The Charter (Article 8) reserves the question of how members participate in managing a group until FDS reaches 20+ active members.



Welcome to FDS0

Why FDS0 Exists

A specific memory from 2017.

When FDS was founded, a lot of people built a Minecraft map together, non-commercial, out of real passion for the maps and each other.

Why this needs to be written down now.

FDS today is still rebuilding itself. As we grow, unwritten norms stop transmitting on their own; without shared protocol, scale becomes chaos.

Why we want to build with you.

FDS0 is the answer to *how do we make FDS feel alive again?* It is also the shared protocol that keeps growth from becoming chaos. We want this with *you* because FDS is not at a size where the work runs itself yet.

Three Roles

Fresh Member.

A member currently in FDS0. That is you. Work through the seminars honestly, ask questions, produce each assignment.

Member.

Anyone who holds an active FDS identity, including you. After FDS0 you drop the *fresh* qualifier. The identity rules from Seminar 2 stay with you.

Mentor.

Any FDS member of Subordinate Manager rank or higher (Charter, Article 17 / 18), assigned to you for the duration of FDS0. Your mentor adapts the curriculum to your background and signs off your checklists.

Your Mentor

What to expect.

A regular session, plus asynchronous channels for short questions. Your mentor reads the seminar with you and explains the parts that need it in your strongest shared language.

What to ask for.

Ask about anything you do not understand. Ask about FDS workflows your mentor uses in their own work. Mentors expect questions; silence is harder to respond to than confusion.

What your mentor will not do.

Your mentor will not write your assignments for you, will not approve work they have not actually looked at themselves, and will not bypass FDS rules to save time.

FDS0 Is Initiation, Not Selection

FDS0 is universal for FDS.

This curriculum was put together by Project-StarFall and is run for every fresh member entering FDS, whichever sub-group you end up working with.

FDS0 is not an entrance exam.

You are already a member. The seminars and the midterm verify that you can carry out the basic FDS workflow safely; they are not designed to filter people out.

FDS0 Is Initiation, Not Selection (Cont'd)

Visible achievement every seminar.

Each seminar has exactly one concrete assignment. You leave each seminar with something to show.

Honest effort is the threshold.

Anyone who does the assignments honestly should pass the midterm and the final project on the first attempt. If a checkpoint goes wrong, the response is to revise, not to be removed.

What FDS0 does not promise.

FDS0 does not promise you a salary, a job, or a fixed role. It promises that if you become a contributing member, FDS treats your long-term participation as something worth sustaining.



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How FDS0 Works

Contribution vs. Assignment

In FDS we say contribution, not assignment.

The word is deliberate. An assignment is something handed to you to perform. A contribution is something you add to the organization, with your name on it.

FDS0 assignments are still called assignments.

They are scaffolding, not real contributions. The final project is where you produce your first real contribution to FDS.

Why the distinction matters.

It changes how you treat the work. An assignment is finished when you submit. A contribution is finished when someone else has accepted it.

The 13 Seminars

The four blocks of the curriculum.

- **Identity block.** Seminars 1-2 (Nature of FDS, MyFDS, identity).
- **Foundations block.** Seminars 3-6 (rules motivation, Linux/Unix, CLI/Markdown, DocServer). Midterm checkpoint after Seminar 6.
- **Collaboration block.** Seminars 7-9 (Git, GitHub, logic).
- **Authoring block.** Seminars 10-13 (LaTeX, AI agents). Final project closes the curriculum.

Pace is flexible.

A typical pace covers the 13 seminars in about a month, but FDS0 is not on a strict clock. Your pace depends on your background and your mentor's availability.

One Assignment per Seminar

Each seminar has exactly one central assignment.

Not three small exercises, not a reading log. One concrete output the mentor can sign off.

The assignment is fixed; the execution path is not.

The central assignment is the same for everyone in the cohort. *How* you complete it is adapted by your mentor to your background.

Why one assignment.

A single visible artifact per seminar is easier to check, easier to record, and easier for you to point at later.

Midterm and Final Project

Midterm after the foundations block.

A checkpoint that verifies the basic FDS workflow: identity safety, rules-as-protection, Markdown, DocServer. If you have done the identity and foundations blocks honestly, you should pass on the first attempt.

Final project after the authoring block.

One small real contribution to FDS, picked with your mentor and carried through the standard FDS workflow. This is the artifact you will point at after FDS0.

Both are checkpoints, not punishments.

A revision after a checkpoint is normal. The audit trail records the checkpoint result so the next stage of your time in FDS has a clear starting point.

Recap

What we covered today.

- **What FDS is:** a non-profit game development team, at `fds.moe` (`doc.fds.moe` for documentation), with members across multiple regions.
- **What FDS produces:** sub-groups Project-StarFall (DocServer, Akari, creative) and PMINE (Hotaru, HCR, research); current centre of gravity reflects the 2024-2025 trajectory.
- **Where FDS is going:** non-profit core; member livelihood grows via sub-groups and subordinate for-profit companies; member control of groups reserved until 20+ active members (Article 8).

Recap (Cont'd)

Welcome to FDS0.

- **Why FDS0:** a way back to the 2017 passion-and-non-commercial energy; shared protocol that keeps growth from becoming chaos.
- **Roles:** fresh member, member, mentor (Subordinate Manager or higher).
- **How it works:** 13 seminars in four blocks, typically about a month at flexible pace; one assignment per seminar; midterm + final project as checkpoints.